

Mukden Incident, 1931

Emboldened -> radical elements within the military -> especially in the Kwantung army -> became more ambitious

- one such figure there was colonel ishiwara kanji.
 - he was convinced that war between Japan and US -> was inevitable and that japan should prepare for it.
 - ishiwara -> also had plans to settle Japanese farmers on Manchuria's large and fertile agricultural lands.
 - he wanted Japan to take control of Manchuria as a colony and build a new society in which all Japanese worked for each other and the emperor -> not themselves or corporations.
- although they did not say so - many of the top commanders in Japanese military felt the same way as ishiwara.
- September 1931 -> Kwantung Army blew up railway tracks at Mukden.
- they blamed it on the Chinese government + used it as an excuse to take over Manchuria.
- By December -> Kwantung Army were in control of most of the region
- in march 1932 -> Japanese renamed Manchuria as Manchukuo.
- in theory it was an independent state - but in reality it as a Japanese colony.
- military in Japan - supported Kwantung Army's actions while the PM and civilian government were unable to control Ishiwara and his supporters.
- this incident -> showed that civilian officers ha only a weak control over military - as military had greater say in japans foreign policy.
- Invasion of Manchuria - was extremely popular with the Japanese public
- Many of them -> saw Manchuria was a solution to Japans economic problems.
- Victory was celebrated in Japan through songs, plays, newsreels, and radio broadcasts.
- Reports from the Japanese governments spy network stated that Manchuria had been a divine wind bringing about a new spirit of solidarity -> overcoming the divisions of recent years.